

KDE4 didn't make it into this release, but you can install it from the online repositories, and that was the main reason for me to install GNOME over KDE 3.5. Although, the KDE4 integration is at par with KDE 3.5, if you are a GNOME user you will be a bit disappointed with the way it's been integrated. The menus are cluttered and applications are scattered across wrong sections. You will find graphics programs under music and vice versa. Figure 4 gives you a glimpse of the default GNOME desktop offered by Sabayon.

It is always good to have alternatives, but how many alternatives will you use at a time? Sabayon includes four Web browsers, nine media players, multiple archive managers, image viewers and other tools. Having too many similar tools makes the system bloated and the OS memory voracious. The distro should have made some shrewd choices on packages. Fewer and better packages might have resulted in a snappier experience.

Sabayon 4 has added a few great utilities. It includes full-blown virtualisation solutions from the geeky Virt-Manager to the user-friendly Virtualbox. Sabayon also includes the Lightscribe media labeller. This tool allows you to create covers for your lightscribe CD/DVD in just a few clicks. You can then use the software to print it on the discs using the Lightscribe DVD/CD Writer.

As for package managers, it has introduced Entropy, which is fully compatible with Gentoo's Emerge package manager. It has also introduced a graphical wrapper called Spritz (see Figure 5) to cope with other high-end package managers available. Spritz aims to be simple, yet powerful. It is still at a nascent stage of development, so it wasn't a surprise when it crashed quite a few times while testing.

With over 8,000 packages you will find nearly all you desire from Spritz, and can install it easily. Spritz looks and performs nearly

similar to Packagekit, but is still not as powerful. Though I'd say its inclusion is a very positive step and is way simpler than the labyrinthine portato package manager.

Closing up!

Sabayon indeed is a great distro, but version 4 didn't measure up to expectations. The poor hardware support, at least in my case, has left a negative impression. I only hope the upcoming revisions are a lot better and more usable than the current one. However, this doesn't mean that Sabayon won't work for you. Considering the impressive amount of work done to improve on the previous versions, Sabayon is a must try even if you don't want to replace your current distro with it.

Overall, the new version left a neutral impression on me. Will I use it? No, because I can't get certain things to work even after editing the core files. But it may give you some good company, so don't hesitate to take it for a spin, at least. 

Sabayon Linux 4r1



Pros:

Plethora of software, pre-installed 3D games, multimedia support out of the box

Cons:

Poor hardware support, poorly managed menus and applications, complex default desktop

Platform: x86, x86-64

Price: Free (as in beer)

Website: www.sabayonlinux.org

Resources

- Home Page: www.sabayonlinux.org
- Sabayon Wiki: wiki.sabayonlinux.org
- Forums: forum.sabayonlinux.org

By: Shashwat Pant

The author is a FOSS enthusiast interested in Qt programming and technology. He is fond of checking out the latest OSS distros and tools.

NACE
move to the next level

TRAINING & CONSULTANCY

Novell.

GOLD TRAINING PARTNER

BECOME AN INDUSTRY
READY OPEN SOURCE
PROFESSIONAL

LINUX
APACHE
MySQL
PHP

Linux Basics
Linux Administration
Linux Networking
Linux Security
OpenOffice.org 3.0

We Also Undertake Linux Server
Maintenance & Integration

CHENNAI

T.NAGAR : 99405 42222
ANNA NAGAR : 97909 25554
ADYAR : 97909 25550
MYLAPORE : 9003033233
AMBATTUR : 9445322869
PERAMBUR : 93808 76090
TAMBARAM : 9283366552
VILLIVAKKAM : 9940233360
VELLORE : 9994241383
SALEM : 9944175120

PONDICHERRY : 97918 53774

BANGALORE : +91 9940022277

HYDERABAD

MALAKPET : 9849462617
ASHOK NAGAR : 9703333839

www.naceedu.com